What Role Did Immigration Attitudes Play in Latinos' 2016-2024 Swing Toward the GOP?*

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Abstract

After the 2012 and 2016 presidential elections, scholars and observers frequently characterized Latino voters as unlikely to support anti-immigration candidates, especially when immigration is salient. However, between 2016 and 2024, Latinos were among the groups that swung the most toward the GOP. Given the mismatch between Donald Trump's strident opposition to unauthorized immigration and Latinos' historically pro-immigration views, understanding the role of Latinos' immigration attitudes in vote choice in this period is theoretically important. Acknowledging that Latinos are not single-issue voters, we investigate this question using multiple high-quality, population-based panels of Latinos (2016-2024). We document a restrictionist turn in Latinos' attitudes alongside perceptions that both parties slightly moderated. We find that Latinos placed just as much weight on immigration policy in their 2024 vote choice as in 2016. Our results suggest that while immigration has not waned in importance for Latinos, changes in attitudes from 2016-2024 somewhat eroded Democrats' advantage on this issue.

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Introduction

Like Americans generally, Latinos' voting preferences have oscillated in recent decades (De la Garza, 1992; Alvarez and Bedolla, 2003; Hajnal and Lee, 2011).[1] Between 2000 and 2004, for example, Republicans increased their Latino support from 35% to 40% (National Council of La Raza, 2012). One recent and notable pro-GOP shift was evident in 2024. By some estimates, had Latino support for Democrats held steady between 2020 and 2024, Trump would have lost the popular vote. Instead, the Democrats' share of the Latino vote dropped by up to 14 percentage points.[2] Even so, the pendulum continues to swing, with just 27% of Latino adults approving of Trump's performance in October 2025 (Im and Noe-Bustamante 2025; see also Equiis Research 2025, Somos Votantes 2025).

For decades, Latinos have been heterogeneous on key dimensions and far from single-issue voters (De la Garza, 1992; Cisneros, 2017; Bromo et al., 2025). Still, in the years before 2024, there was some evidence that Latinos were moving towards the GOP, as voters increasingly aligned their ideology with their vote choice (Sides, Tesler and Vavreck, 2019; Sides, Tausanovitch and Vavreck, 2023; Corral and Leal, 2024; Fraga, Velez and West, 2025). Indeed, Latinos have long included sizable fractions of Republicans, people who support restricting immigration, and those who prioritize their American identification over their racial/ethnic identification (De la Garza, 1992; Beltrán, 2010; Barreto and Segura, 2014; Hickel Jr et al., 2020; Pérez and Cobian, 2024; Pérez, Lee and Luna, 2025; Múzquiz and Junn, 2025).

In 2024, however, there was some reason to expect that the pro-GOP trend might subside. Unauthorized immigration[4] had taken a backseat to COVID in 2020. But the issue was

[1] We follow prior research by using "Latino." We define this term following the U.S. federal government to exclude people from Brazil (Passel and Krogstad, 2023). We also exclude people from Spain.

[2] Latinos backed Harris over Trump 51%-46% in 2024 after backing Biden over Trump 65%-32% in 2020, according to the National Exit Poll (CNN, 2020, 2024).[3] According to Catalist, Latino support for Democrats fell from 70% for Clinton in 2016 to 63% for Biden in 2020 and 54% for Harris in 2024 (Catalist, 2025). Using election returns, Equis Research (2024) estimates at least a 13 percentage-point shift between 2016 and 2024.

[4] This paper focuses on unauthorized immigration, but sometimes uses the umbrella term "immigration."

again highly salient in 2024, as Appendix B's content analysis illustrates. One long-standing model of the relationship between issue attitudes and vote choice holds that voters are especially likely to connect issue attitudes with their vote choice when issues are politically salient (Carmines and Stimson 1989; Mendelberg 2001; Valentino, Hutchings and White 2002; Vavreck 2009; Sides, Tesler and Vavreck 2019; Hopkins 2021; see also Iyengar and Kinder 1987; Gelman and King 1993; Lenz 2013).

Further, Donald Trump's immigration rhetoric in 2024 emphasized mass deportations. This stance was arguably even more extreme—and potentially more threatening to Latinos—than his 2016 emphasis on constructing a border wall (see especially Margalit and Solodoch, 2022). Latinos have traditionally leaned towards the Democrats' less restrictive position on immigration (e.g. Abrajano and Alvarez, 2010; Barreto and Collingwood, 2015; McCann and Jones-Correa, 2020; Morales, Rodriguez and Schaller, 2020; Wallace and Zepeda-Millán, 2020),[5] and extensive research finds that anti-immigration rhetoric and policies threaten and mobilize Latinos (Pantoja, Ramirez and Segura, 2001; Bedolla, 2005; Bowler, Nicholson and Segura, 2006; Fraga et al., 2010; Zepeda-Millán, 2014; White, 2016; Zepeda-Millán, 2017; Jones-Correa, Al-Faham and Cortez, 2018; Roman, Walker and Barreto, 2022). In short, there was a real possibility that Trump's anti-immigration positions, along with the issue's renewed salience, would push some Latinos to the Democrats in 2024—or at least slow a pro-GOP shift driven by other factors.

Ex ante, though, Latinos returning to the Democrats was not the only plausible outcome. The stabilizing influence of political partisanship might have worked to slow the pro-GOP shift after 2020 without reversing it (Pérez, 2021; Hopkins, Kaiser and Pérez, 2023; Pérez, Lee and Luna, 2025; Wakefield, 2025; but see Hajnal and Lee, 2011; Sanchez and Vargas, 2016). Like voters generally, economic concerns or other issues may have been paramount for Latinos (Vavreck, 2009; Brenan, 2024), and may have dwarfed any influence of immigration attitudes. Changes in the nature of the immigration issue may have also dampened its capacity to move

[5]However, efforts for comprehensive immigration reform have commonly joined liberal policies for those already in the country with increased border restrictions (Nicholls, 2020; Wong, 2017; Zepeda-Millán, 2017).

Latinos to the Democrats. In 2000, 44% of Latinos were foreign born, a factor which helped explain their political distinctiveness (Barreto 2010, pg. 26; Barreto and Segura 2014). By 2021, however, that fraction had shrunk to 32% (Moslimani and Noe-Bustamante, 2023). This increasing distance between some Latinos and the immigration experience may shift the politics of immigration. Second, the sources of unauthorized immigration have changed. In 2008, Mexican citizens accounted for 91% of U.S. Border Patrol apprehensions (Sapp, 2011). During the 2021-2023 period, however, that fraction dropped to 34%, potentially changing the relationship between American Latinos—60% of whom are of Mexican descent (Appendix Table G3)—and unauthorized immigration.

What role, if any, did immigration attitudes play in Latinos' movement towards the GOP in 2024? Although immigration is not the only influential issue, studying it provides an opportunity to test theories of issue attitudes and vote choice. Here, we investigate three mechanisms that may help explain the improvement in GOP performance with Latinos (2016-2024). Those mechanisms are: changes in public opinion (*attitude change*); changes to perceived candidate positions on immigration (*party repositioning*); and changes to the importance voters placed on immigration (*changing issue weights*). The third of these captures the prospect that the economy or other issues may have crowded out immigration attitudes. Together, these mechanisms encompass the key components linking issue attitudes to vote choice and are derived from a simple issue voting model formalized in Appendix C. We use this framework to motivate our operationalization of key constructs and statistical analyses.

To test each mechanism empirically, we employ multiple surveys, including two separate population-based panels of Latinos in English and Spanish conducted by GfK (2016-2018) and NORC (2024). Given our research question and our interest in minority groups that can be under-represented by some survey modes, there is particular value in employing these high-quality, population-based samples which have been shown to be especially valuable in representing Latinos (Barreto et al., 2018; Hopkins et al., 2024; Mercer and Lau, 2023). (As Appendix Table A1 illustrates, prominent recent research on Latinos' voting behavior has

only occasionally employed population-based samples.) These surveys allow us to track Latinos' attitudes toward unauthorized immigration along with their perceptions of the parties' stances. Measuring public opinion and party platforms on the same scale is a key advantage of these surveys.

We first characterize the issue attitudes that were associated with backing the GOP in 2024. Immigration attitudes prove predictive—but so do attitudes on climate change, foreign police, discrimination, and especially perceptions of the national economy. Our subsequent analyses focus on immigration attitudes, acknowledging that they are only one piece of the broader puzzle.

Of the three mechanisms we identify, we find that the pro-Trump shift among Latino citizens is most clearly associated with changing attitudes on immigration.[6] After 2016, Latinos became more favorable toward immigration restrictions, bringing their views closer to Trump's. This shift was coupled with the perception that both parties moderated slightly on immigration.

The net effect of attitude change and (perceived) party repositioning is that a larger share of Latinos saw themselves as closer to Republicans on immigration. In 2016, only 21% of Latinos placed themselves closer to the Republican Party on immigration. By 2024, that share rose to over 32%. Using additional data, we show that Latinos were not unique over this period: white Americans also became more supportive of immigration restriction.

To examine the weight placed on immigration, we regress vote choice on respondents' distance from the perceived party platforms. We find remarkable consistency in the weight given to immigration over this time. Respondents' perceived distance from the two parties on immigration was equally related to their vote choice in 2016, 2020, and 2024. What changed was Latinos' immigration attitudes, not the weight they placed on those attitudes.

Together, our results demonstrate how Latinos' changing issue attitudes muted the Democrats' immigration advantage. Across different years and data sets, the weight that

[6] We restrict our analyses to U.S. citizens as we are studying voting behavior.

Latinos place on immigration is highly stable, suggesting the limits of generalizing from the extensive political science research emphasizing changing issue salience as an explanation for shifting vote choices (e.g. Carmines and Stimson 1989; Mendelberg 2001; Valentino, Hutchings and White 2002; Sides, Tesler and Vavreck 2019; but see Lenz 2013). Immigration was just as highly correlated with Latinos' vote choice in 2024 as in 2016, but the increasing support for restrictionism meant that the issue no longer advantaged Democrats as decisively. These findings reinforce evidence that Latinos are not a pro-immigration issue public (e.g. Cisneros, 2017; Velez, 2024) while also encouraging a reconsideration of models of vote change foregrounding issue salience.

Mechanisms Linking Immigration Views and Vote Choice

We first describe the theoretical framework that guides our analyses. Based on a simple spatial model of voting, developed formally in Appendix C, we identify three mechanisms connecting immigration attitudes to vote choice.

Attitude Change. First, it may be that Latinos moved right on immigration, bringing their views closer to the GOP's. If so, classic spatial voting models predict an increase in Trump's vote share (Enelow and Hinich, 1984). During the Biden administration, there was a dramatic increase in the number of migrants crossing the southern border (Sullivan, 2023), which may have contributed to a widespread thermostatic reaction against immigration (Wlezien, 1995).[7] In this view, while Latinos started from a more pro-immigration baseline, they nevertheless were likely to swing in the same direction as other Americans (Page and Shapiro, 1992; Coppock, 2023).

Party Repositioning. The next mechanism emphasizes the parties' perceived positions. Under issue voting, even if voters maintain a constant position, their support may shift if they perceive the parties' positions to change (see also Downs, 1957; Jessee, 2012). Might

[7] In Gallup surveys, the share of Americans saying that immigration should be decreased rose from 31% in June 2021 to 55% in June 2024 before dropping back to 30% in 2025 (Gallup, 2025).

Trump have been perceived as moderating on immigration after 2016? This mechanism seems plausible for 2020, a campaign in which COVID overshadowed other issues (Sides, Tausanovitch and Vavreck, 2023). However, this explanation seems less credible in 2024, which featured Trump's sustained anti-immigrant rhetoric and proposals, including claims that immigrants are "poisoning the blood of our country" (Gibson, 2023). Still, it is an empirical question whether Trump was perceived to be more moderate on immigration in 2024 than in 2016. Even if perceptions of Trump's stance did not change, if his successive opponents were perceived to move leftward, that could also explain defections of voters with moderate immigration stances.

Changing Issue Weights. A final possibility is that Latinos may have come to care less about immigration and more about other issues on which their views align more closely with Trump's. Longstanding theories in political science—including framing, priming, agenda-setting, and heresthetics—explain how political actors, media outlets, and external events can shape the issues that people focus on when voting (Riker, 1986; Iyengar and Kinder, 1987; Carmines and Stimson, 1989; Valentino, Hutchings and White, 2002; Hillygus and Shields, 2008; Vavreck, 2009; Lenz, 2013; Sides, Tesler and Vavreck, 2019; Chong and Druckman, 2007). Though these theories vary in their psychological mechanisms, they share a core insight: even if voters' opinions are consistent between elections, their vote choices may shift because they place differing weight on specific opinions.[8] We group these theories together under the term "issue weights" because they make common predictions about the changing relationship between issue attitudes and vote choice. For instance, suppose that for at least some Latinos, criminal justice became more important to voters' decision-making calculus in 2024 (Pérez and Cobian, 2024). If Latinos hold relatively conservative attitudes on this issue, it could drive them toward the Republican Party, as they are primed to think about candidate selection on a dimension other than immigration (Fraga, Velez and West, 2025; see also d'Urso and Roman, 2024).

[8] In the formal model in Appendix C, these mechanisms correspond to an increase in the utility weight on a particular issue.

We investigate each mechanism in turn. We measure the public's views on immigration policy and its perception of the candidates' stances (measured on the same scale), allowing us to directly analyze attitude change and perceived party repositioning. We infer issue weights by analyzing how vote choice is correlated with the policy distance between voters' views on immigration and their perception of the candidates' views.

Data and Methods

A key contribution of this article is its use of multiple high-quality, population-based panels, two of which targeted or over-sampled Latinos and were administered to the same respondents multiple times in Spanish and English. Given that we employ various surveys in our analyses, and given that they have differing strengths, Table 1 summarizes the surveys.

2016-2018 GfK Panel. This panel surveyed Latinos in three waves using the KnowledgePanel; panelists were recruited via random-digit dialing and address-based sampling (Hopkins, Kaiser and Pérez, 2023). The three waves were fielded in spring 2016, fall 2016, and fall 2018. In the first wave, 49% of invited panelists completed the survey, giving us 820 Hispanic respondents. The sample size in subsequent waves was 452 (wave 2) and 223 (wave 3). Appendix Table G2 provides key descriptive statistics and allows for an assessment of attrition. While attrition doesn't affect most variables, there are meaningful declines in the fraction of respondents surveyed in Spanish and an increase in the average education level across waves. Appendix Table G2 also permits a comparison between the baseline wave and benchmark data from the American Community Survey (ACS) which reinforces that this population-based sample tracks some features of the Latino population well while over-estimating mean income and educational attainment.

2024 NORC Panel. This two-wave panel of American adults was drawn from the AmeriSpeak panel.[9] The first wave was conducted between February 20 and March 18, 2024, and the second wave between September 18 and October 14, 2024. The survey included an oversample of Latino respondents ($n = 824$ in wave 1, $n = 571$ in wave 2; these figures include non-citizens).[10] Panelists primarily took the survey online, but 93 respondents (11 Latinos) were surveyed via telephone.[11] Appendix Table G3 details descriptive statistics and illustrates the minimal effects of attrition. It, too, provides ACS benchmarks for comparison. Here, mean education and income are very close to their benchmarks. However, the weighted data downweights Latinos of Mexican ancestry from 48% to 42% of respondents, both of which are lower than the 60% benchmark.

Survey	Dates	Panel?	Sampling Frame	N	Key Questions
GfK	Spring 2016	Wave 1	Population-based	820	Vote, Immigration Attitudes
GfK	Fall 2016	Wave 2	Population-based	452	Vote, Immig. Att. Party Pos.
GfK	Fall 2018	Wave 3	Population-based	223	Vote, Immig. Att. Party Pos.
ISCAP/GfK	Fall 2020		Population-based	111	Vote, Immig. Att. Party Pos.
NORC	Spring 2024	Wave 1	Population-based	824	Vote, Various Issue Attitudes, Party Pos.
NORC	Fall 2024	Wave 2	Population-based	571	Vote, Various Issue Attitudes, Party Pos.
CES	2018-2024		Online/Opt-in	40,282	Vote, Various Immig. Att.
AP VoteCast	2018-2024		Mixed	48,560	Vote, Various Immig. Att.

Table 1: This table lists the various surveys employed here with their time periods, sampling frames, inclusion as part of a panel, Latino sample size (N), and key questions. "Att." stands for "attitudes."

[9]Respondents to the AmeriSpeak panel were originally sampled via probability and address-based sampling, and are then empaneled using mail, telephone, and face-to-face visits.

[10]The panel recruitment rate is 22.3% and the wave one survey completion rate was 18.5%.

[11]11% of the 2024 wave 1 respondents took the survey in Spanish.

ISCAP Panel. An additional data source is the Institute for the Study of Citizens and Politics panel (Mutz, 2018; Hopkins, 2021), which is also drawn from GfK's Knowledge Panel. Prior research observed a meaningful pro-GOP shift between 2016 and 2020 (e.g. Sides, Tausanovitch and Vavreck, 2023; Fraga, Velez and West, 2025), so it is valuable to measure Latinos' immigration attitudes and vote choice in 2020. It is also important to assess whether any trends we observe are unique to Latinos. The ISCAP panel permits us to do both, as it asked our primary measure of immigration attitudes in seven waves between 2012 and 2020. The Latino sample sizes are small ($n = 111$ in fall 2020) and the survey was conducted only in English. But this data set gives insight about Latino attitudes in an additional election year and helps disentangle longer-term trends from short-run fluctuations. All three panels—the GfK Latinos panel, the NORC panel, and the ISCAP panel—use probability-based samples, allowing for more credible comparisons between them.

Primary Immigration Measure. While Americans react differently to different aspects of immigration (Levy and Wright, 2020; Margalit and Solodoch, 2022; Kustov, 2025), we track the main fault lines of debate by emphasizing unauthorized immigration. Specifically, our primary measure comes from this *Pathway* question:

> On immigration, some people argue that U.S. policy should focus on returning illegal immigrants to their native countries. Others argue that U.S. policy should focus on creating a pathway to U.S. citizenship for illegal immigrants. Still, others are somewhere in between. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this?

Respondents place themselves on a 7-point scale, where 1 indicates that the U.S. should deport illegal immigrants and 7 indicates that the U.S. should create a pathway to citizenship.

Additionally, several waves asked respondents to place the parties on the same scale. This enables us to observe perceptions of the parties' platforms on a common scale alongside public opinion, data we employ to investigate party repositioning and the weight voters place

on immigration.

Additional Data. As complements to these panels, we also analyze the Cooperative Election Survey (CES) and, in Appendix F, data from the AP VoteCast surveys. The CES is a large, collaborative survey that YouGov has run online annually since 2006. The advantage of the CES is that it contains several additional questions about policy preferences on immigration, ensuring our conclusions are not driven by a single survey question. However, the CES has three downsides relative to our primary surveys. First, it does not use a probability-based sample, which are known to be the gold standard (Chang and Krosnick, 2009; Yeager et al., 2011) and which can be especially important when studying Latinos (Mercer and Lau 2023; see also Hopkins et al. 2024). Second, the wording of immigration questions changed in 2018, meaning we cannot compare responses before 2018 to those afterward (Sides, 2023) and so omit them. Finally, the CES is only conducted in English. Appendix E provides more details on the CES questions.

In our analyses, we measure vote choice as follows:

$$\text{Vote Choice}_i = \begin{cases} -1 & \text{if respondent voted for Democrat} \\ 0 & \text{if respondent abstained or voted 3rd party} \\ 1 & \text{if respondent voted for Republican} \end{cases}$$

This trichotomous coding captures the fact that the decision to abstain is electorally meaningful and related to voters' attitudes toward the candidates. As such, restricting attention to respondents backing a major-party candidate is a form of selection on the dependent variable (Grimmer, Marble and Tanigawa-Lau, 2024). The mean of this variable is the Republican vote share minus the Democratic vote share as a proportion of the voting-eligible population.

Table 2 shows vote shares among Latinos in 2016 and 2024 across ancestry groups, as measured in our data. There was a dramatic increase in the share of Latinos supporting

	Spring 2016				Fall 2024			
Descent	GOP	Other	Democrat	n	GOP	Other	Democrat	n
All	10.9%	26.0%	63.1%	572	36.2%	18.6%	45.2%	460
Mexican	7.5%	26.3%	66.2%	322	29.7%	19.2%	51.1%	225
Cuban	23.6%	34.5%	41.9%	29	51.0%	08.6%	40.4%	41
Other	14.6%	24.4%	61.0%	221	38.6%	20.6%	40.9%	194

Table 2: Vote preference among Latino citizens. Calculated using weighted means, spring 2016 and fall 2024 samples of Latino citizens interviewed in English and Spanish. "Other" includes non-voters, those with no preference, and third-party supporters.

Trump, from 11% in 2016 to 36% in 2024, along with a concomitant fall in support for Democrats, from 63% to 45%. (While 11% is very low, note that this comes from spring 2016, when Trump had not yet wrapped up the GOP nomination contest against Ted Cruz, and that 26% of respondents declined to back either party. In our fall 2016 wave, 20% of respondents supporting a major-party candidate backed Trump.) This shift is evident across groups. For a more detailed breakdown of changes among Latino subgroups, see Appendix G.1.

Issue Attitudes and Voting in 2024

Immigration has been a consistently salient issue (see Appendix B), but it is far from the only issue influencing Latinos' vote choice. As Table 1 demonstrates, our 2024 wave is best positioned to assess the role of immigration *relative to other issues*. As a first step, we fit regression models for both 2024 waves to assess the predictive power of the immigration measure relative to attitudes on other salient issues. Those issues include government spending, assistance targeting Black Americans, discrimination, climate change, Israel/Palestine, and Ukraine as well as retrospective economic evaluations. (See Appendix D for question wording.) We use the trichotomous vote choice variable described above.

Figure 1 plots standardized effect sizes for each variable. National sociotropic economic perceptions are most strongly associated with vote choice. But immigration attitudes, cli-

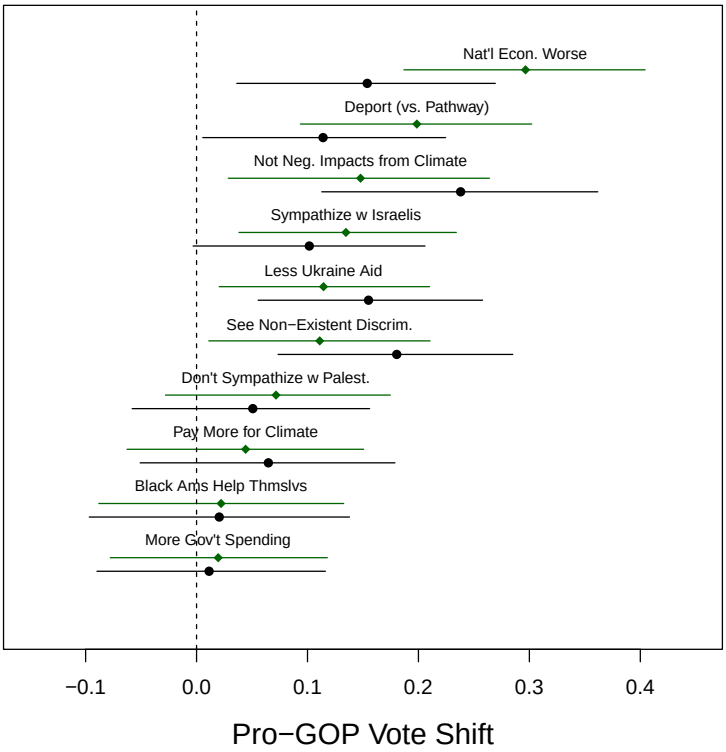

Figure 1: Predicted changes in supporting Trump over Biden/Harris estimated from regression models in the spring (top/green line) or fall (bottom/black line) 2024 panel waves. Points indicate predicted shift given a one-standard deviation change in the independent variable holding all others (including demographics not shown) constant.

mate change attitudes, perceptions of discrimination, and foreign policy attitudes prove highly correlated as well. At least in 2024, immigration attitudes were one factor among several. The stability of the coefficients from spring to fall 2024 is also noteworthy given that the Democratic candidate changed from Joe Biden in wave 1 to Kamala Harris in wave 2. Shifting candidates from a white man to a woman of color did little to disrupt the basic mapping of issue attitudes to candidate support.

While these results provide initial evidence on the importance of immigration in Latinos' vote choices in 2024, they cannot distinguish between the mechanisms previously discussed. In particular, the coefficients from this regression combine candidate positioning and the

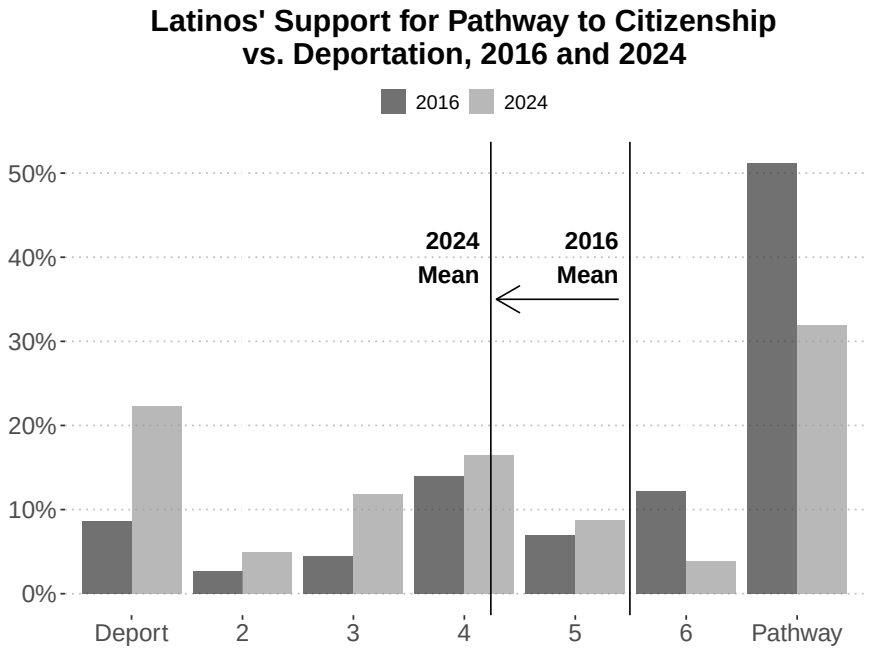

Figure 2: Latinos' attitudes on unauthorized immigration (1 = deportation, 7 = pathway to citizenship) in March/April 2016 and September/October 2024.

weight voters place on each issue. Our subsequent analyses investigate these mechanisms more formally.

Attitude Change

We next analyze answers to the *Pathway* question on the GfK and NORC panels, then turn to CES data. Figure 2 plots the distribution of responses to the *Pathway* question among Latinos in the March/April 2016 and September/October 2024 surveys. Latinos became significantly more restrictionist over this period. In 2016, respondents' average self-placement was 5.4 on the 1 to 7 scale. By 2024, sentiment had turned against providing a pathway to citizenship somewhat, and the average self-placement was 4.2. In 2016, 51% of Latino respondents answered 7 on this scale—the most pro-pathway response option. That number dropped to 32% in 2024. Likewise, the share of Latinos saying illegal immigrants should be deported grew from 9% to 22%.

In shifting against a pathway to citizenship, Latinos mirror broader changes in the American public. Appendix H.1 Figure H3 and Table H6 use the ISCAP panel to show that even in 2024, Latinos remained more supportive of a pathway to citizenship and less supportive of deportation than non-Hispanic white Americans.

These findings are corroborated by the CES's more expansive set of immigration policy questions. We combine 6 questions, asked intermittently between 2018 and 2024, to generate an immigration policy index.[12] We standardize the scale so that its distribution has mean 0 and variance 1 in 2018, with higher values indicating more restrictionist attitudes.

Figure 3 plots immigration restrictionism for Latinos and non-Latinos between 2018 and 2024. Trump's first few years marked a low-point in Latinos' restrictionist attitudes. In 2018, the average was -0.34. However, through the remainder of Trump's first term and Biden's presidency, there was an increase in Latinos' restrictionist attitudes. By 2023, Latinos' average placement on this scale rose to -0.14. This swing represents 20% of the 2018 standard deviation. In short, we find strong evidence of *attitude change* among Latinos. A pronounced gap between Latinos and non-Latinos in immigration attitudes remains, albeit one that has decreased.

The appendices present additional analyses of the attitude change mechanism. First, Appendix H.2 examines whether the changes are driven by Mexican-descended citizens—who possibly could have moved rightward as the composition of unauthorized migrants at the southern border shifted to Central American asylum-seekers (Van Hook, Gelatt and Ruiz Soto, 2023). However, we find that Mexican-descended respondents are consistently *more* supportive of a pathway to citizenship than other Latinos, even in 2024. Second, Appendix H.3 plots results for individual CES items and find similar temporal patterns. Third, Appendix F presents analysis of AP VoteCast data from 2018-2024, which further corroborates these findings.

[12]See Appendix E for the question wordings and index creation methods. The question format changed in 2018, so we restrict our analyses to years after that.

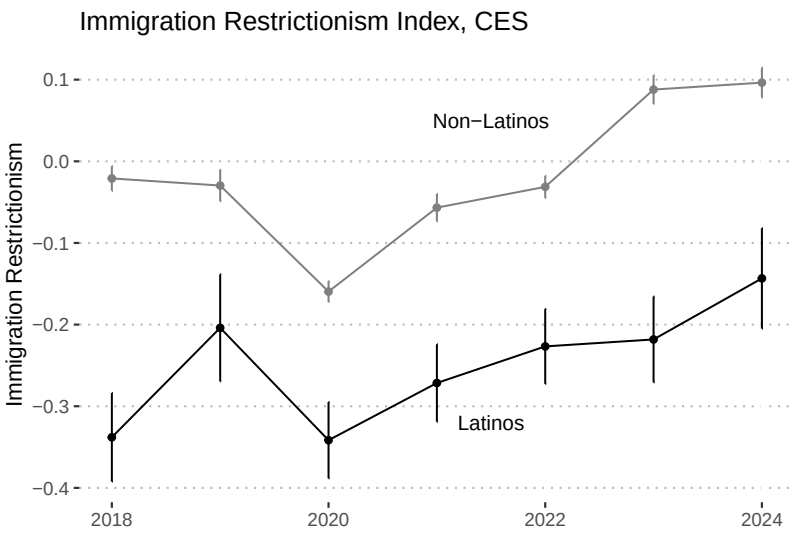

Figure 3: Average attitudes toward on immigration policy scale. Averages use survey weights; standard errors calculated accounting for weighting. Bars show 90% confidence intervals. Data: CES (2018-2024).

Party Repositioning

The distribution of public opinion is only one component of issue voting; the parties' perceived positions also matter. To measure perceived positions, we turn to questions from the 2016, 2018, 2020, and 2024 surveys asking respondents to place the Democratic and Republican parties on the *Pathway* question. This question allows us to measure Latinos' perceptions of the parties' positions and their own attitudes on the same scale over time.

Figure 4 shows Latinos' average self-placement and their average placement of the parties. The self-placement data simply reiterates that public opinion moved in a restrictionist direction over this time period. From fall 2016 to fall 2024, the average self-placement fell from 5.44 to 4.26, a difference of 1.18. While it is important to acknowledge the increased uncertainty about the fall 2020 estimate of 4.50, it is instructive that Latinos' shifting attitudes do not appear to be a purely thermostatic response to Biden—in fact, the shift was evident before Biden's 2021 inauguration.

Respondents perceived the Democratic Party to have moved in a restrictionist direction over time. In fall 2016, Latino respondents placed Democrats at 5.75, indicating a perception

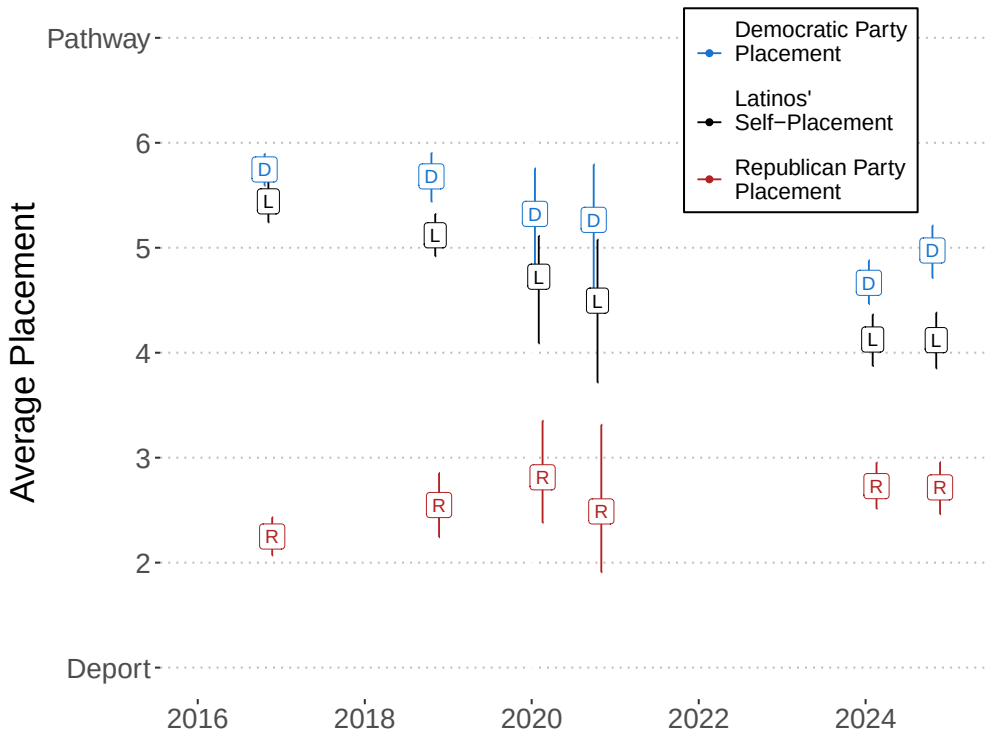

Figure 4: Latino respondents' placement of themselves, the Democratic Party, and the Republican Party on the *Pathway* variable (1-7). Lower values indicate more restrictionist policies. Points show weighted means and lines show bootstrapped 95% confidence intervals. The 2016 and 2018 estimates come from the GfK panel. The 2020 estimates come from the ISCAP panel and the 2024 estimates come from the NORC panel.

that Hillary Clinton's platform was very tolerant toward unauthorized immigrants. By the fall of 2020, Latinos came to perceive the Democrats as somewhat less supportive of unauthorized immigrants, rating the party at 5.27 on average. That figure would drop further to 4.97 by the fall of 2024, a decline of 0.78 from 2016. While the Democratic Party was seen as more restrictionist in 2024 than 2016, this shift did not keep pace with the change in public opinion. At the same time, respondents perceived that the Republican Party became slightly more tolerant of unauthorized immigrants between 2016 and 2024. In 2016, the average placement of the Republican Party was 2.25—reflecting the pro-wall stance staked out by Trump that year. It had moderated by fall 2020, rising to 2.49, and reached 2.72 by the fall of 2024.

Taken together, the average Latino's views toward immigration moved closer to the Re-

publican Party's stance. The average distance between respondents' own views and their placement of Republicans was cut in half, from 3.19 in 2016 to 1.54 in 2024. Most of this change is attributable to public opinion moving in a restrictionist direction; however, some is also attributable to perceived GOP moderation. By the same token, the average Latino respondent was further from the Democrats in 2024 than in 2016, from 0.304 to 0.717.[13]

Issue Weights

The final electoral change mechanism is the *issue weight* placed on immigration. Even if citizens differ markedly from a politician on a given issue, that only matters to the extent that citizens prioritize that issue when voting. Latinos were generally more aligned with Democrats on immigration throughout this period, albeit to a declining extent. As a result, a decrease in the weight placed on immigration should reduce Democratic support.[14]

To estimate the weight placed on immigration, we fit regression models predicting respondents' vote choice as a function of their *Pathway* response along with their perception of the parties' stances on this item. Recall that the outcome variable is -1 for a Democratic vote, 1 for a Republican vote, and 0 for an abstention or third-party vote. The main predictor measures the degree to which the respondents' opinion on immigration is closer to perceived position of the Republican Party (higher values) or Democratic Party (lower values):

$$\begin{aligned}\text{GOP Immig. Advantage}_i = &\underbrace{|\text{Democratic Placement}_i - \text{Self}_i|}_{\text{Perceived distance from Democrat}} \\ &- \underbrace{|\text{GOP Placement}_i - \text{Self}_i|}_{\text{Perceived distance from GOP}}. \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

This variable runs from -6 to 6. Positive values indicate that the respondent perceives the

[13]Table G5 shows this data differently, demonstrating a large increase in the share of Latinos who place themselves closer to the Republican Party than the Democratic Party on immigration.

[14]As Appendix C shows formally, the direction and magnitude of the change in vote share depends on the Republicans' relative advantage on immigration vis-a-vis other issues. Evidence suggests that Latinos may be better aligned with Republicans on other issues, such as crime, suggesting that a decrease in immigration issue weight should benefit Republicans (Fraga, Velez and West, 2025).

Republican's immigration stance to be closer to their own than the Democrats'.

We employ OLS to estimate issue weights using the following regression separately for each election:

$$\text{Vote Choice}_i = \alpha + w\,\text{GOP Immig. Advantage}_i + X_i'\beta + \varepsilon_i,$$

In this model, X_i is a vector of control variables for respondent i, α is an intercept, and ε_i is an individual-level error term.[15] The coefficient w is the estimated issue weight. Substantively, it represents the average increase in net support for the Republican for a 1-point shift in perceived closeness to the Republican. Within a spatial voting model, it represents the average weight placed on agreement on immigration in voters' utility functions (Appendix C).

Table 3 shows the results. In 2016, we estimate an immigration issue weight of $w_{2016} = 0.127$. In 2020, with a meaningfully smaller sample, it was $w_{2020} = 0.163$, which is statistically indistinguishable from 2016. In 2024, we estimate $w_{2024} = 0.136$, which is again indistinguishable from 2016.

These coefficients tell us that a one-point net shift in immigration attitudes toward the Republican is associated with a 12 to 16 percentage-point increase in net votes for the Republican. Interpreted through the lens of the issue voting model, candidates pay a substantial penalty for deviating from respondents' preferred immigration policies. The similarity of the coefficients over time indicates that changes in issue weights cannot explain the change in Latinos' support for Trump.

[15] These control variables include age, gender, education, income, an indicator for being born in the U.S., and an indicator for taking the survey in Spanish. We do not control for party identification, as it is plausibly downstream relative to immigration attitudes and positions. As such, conditioning on party ID would be controlling for a post-treatment variable.

	Trump vs. Clinton Fall 2016	Trump vs. Biden Fall 2020	Trump vs. Harris Fall 2024
Republican Immig. Advantage	0.127*	0.163*	0.136*
	(0.012)	(0.024)	(0.013)
Education (Years)	0.007	−0.061	−0.035
	(0.012)	(0.036)	(0.022)
Spanish Interview	−0.029		−0.099
	(0.111)		(0.155)
Female	−0.015	0.085	−0.135
	(0.075)	(0.156)	(0.084)
Age (Years)	0.245	−0.000	−0.002
	(0.236)	(0.006)	(0.003)
Income (in 1,000s)	−0.000	−0.000	−0.006
	(0.001)	(0.002)	(0.011)
Born in U.S.	0.073		−0.004
	(0.099)		(0.109)
Intercept	−0.463*	0.818	0.635
	(0.221)	(0.631)	(0.336)
R^2	0.354	0.356	0.244
N	267	105	388

Table 3: Regression models predicting support for Trump (1), neither/don't know/didn't vote (0), or Clinton/Harris (-1) on the covariates listed separately for the 2016-2018, 2020 and 2024 panels. "Republican Immigration Advantage" measures how much closer the respondent is to the Republican candidate on immigration than to the Democratic candidate. Higher values indicate a closer placement to the Republicans relative to the Democrats. $^*p < 0.05$

Subgroup Differences

Does the weight Latino voters place on immigration vary with subgroups or over time? To explore this question, we estimate the same models separately for dichotomous subgroups in Figure 5. For example, the top row of the left-hand side of Figure 5 reports separate coefficients for the GOP immigration advantage for the 204 respondents with education levels at or lower than the median versus the 127 respondents with above-median educational attainment in 2016. We find that, in 2016, older respondents and those surveyed in English generate larger coefficients—indicating that they place slightly more weight on immigration than younger respondents and those interviewed in Spanish. But every coefficient is positive

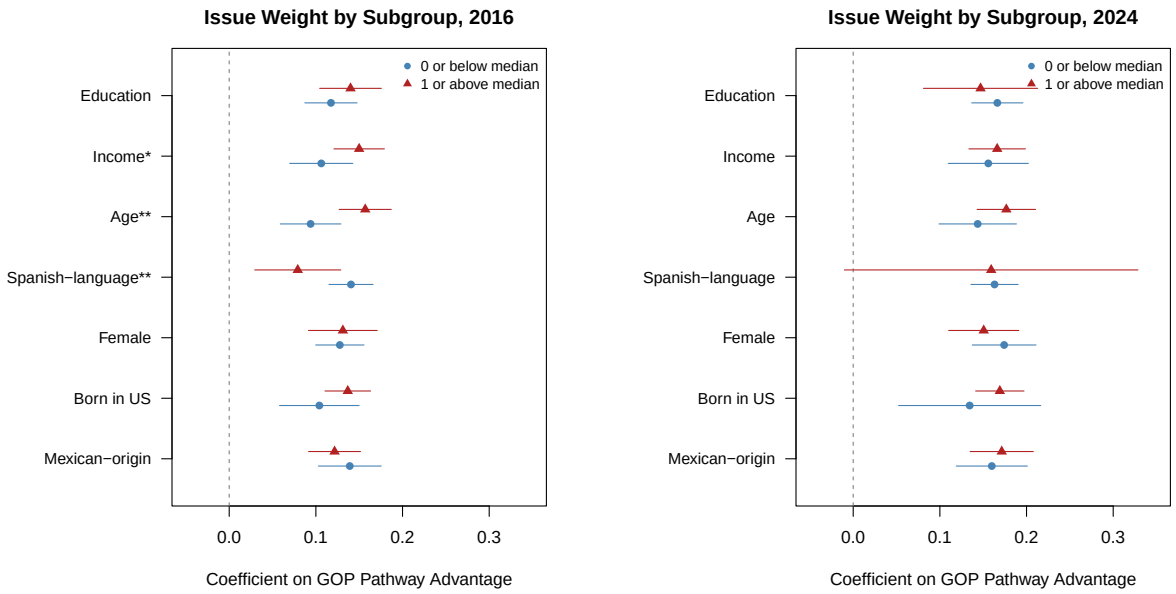

Figure 5: This figure shows coefficients on GOP immigration advantage when predicting support for Trump vs. the Democratic candidate in the spring 2016 (left) and spring 2024 (right) data, with samples split by covariates. All regressions include the remaining covariates. For continuous variables (education, income, and age), the sample is split above the median. Bars show 95% confidence intervals. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$ for the hypothesis of no significant difference between subgroups.

and they are frequently similar in magnitude. In 2024, no groups stand out as being especially influenced by the GOP's immigration advantage. Overall, our core finding holds broadly across Latino subgroups.

Within-Campaign Stability and Robustness

Thus far, we have found that attitude change is a more important driver of electoral change than changing issue weights. We next conduct analyses to understand whether the stability of issue weights holds within campaigns and when controlling for party ID.

Our approach to estimating issue weights relies on observing both respondents' own positions and their perceptions of the candidates' positions. Still, prior research typically estimates models without accounting for party positions. Further, data limitations prevent us from estimating the full models for the spring 2016 wave. Accordingly, Appendix I.1

presents models that regress vote choice on the *Pathway* variable alongside basic controls. We again find remarkable stability within campaigns, with virtually identical coefficients for *Pathway* at different points in time—similar to the results in Figure 1. These results reinforce the core findings that undercut priming-based accounts of campaign changes.

Next, Appendix Table H7 demonstrates that the core result also holds when controlling for political partisanship—albeit with diminished magnitude, as expected given the endogenous relationship between attitudes and partisanship. Specifically, the weight placed on immigration in 2016 is very similar to the weight in 2024. That table also demonstrates that for 2024, when we have the requisite measures, the core result is robust to including national retrospective economic perceptions, too. These findings reinforce the robustness of our core results. Both across and within elections, immigration attitudes were stably integrated with vote choice.

Finally, another potential interpretation of these results is that Latinos became Republicans for other reasons and then updated their immigration attitudes to bring them in line with their partisanship (Lenz, 2013). We probe this possibility of "projection" in two ways. First, Table I12 shows a strong correlation between voters' self-placement on *Pathway* and vote choice, even after conditioning on partisanship—suggesting that immigration attitudes are important for vote choice even within partisan groups. Second, using panel data from 2024, we regress changes in vote choice (between the February-March and the September-October waves) on changes in immigration attitudes and partisanship. Table I13 shows that changes in immigration attitudes predict changes in vote choice, while changes in partisanship do not—the opposite of what would be expected under projection. While we cannot definitively rule out projection or other spurious correlations, these results suggest that issue voting is more likely (see also Mummolo, Peterson and Westwood, 2019; Orr and Huber, 2020).

Comparing with non-Hispanic White Americans

Above, we uncovered striking stability in the issue weights mapping Latinos' immigration attitudes to their vote choices. Is that stability specific to Latinos, who may place particular emphasis on immigration, or is it more general? In Appendix Table J14, we replicate our analyses using ISCAP data and NORC data for non-Hispanic white respondents, for whom sample sizes are sufficient to permit such analyses. Across years and different data sets, the immigration issue weight is remarkably stable: it varies only in the third decimal place, between 0.144 (October 2016), 0.143 (February 2024), and 0.147 (September 2024). Those estimates are indistinguishable from the comparable estimates for Latinos. For example, the one-sided p-value associated with testing whether equality of coefficients for white and Latino respondents in 2024 is 0.25. In sum, throughout this time period, the connection between immigration attitudes and vote choice was very steady and similar in magnitude for both whites and Latinos.

Discussion and Conclusion

After its 2012 presidential loss, the Republican Party issued an "autopsy" report warning that the party's harsh stance on immigration had become a "litmus test" for Latinos. The report concluded that the party needed to embrace immigration reform to win Latinos' votes (Republican National Committee, 2013). It reflected a view of Latinos as an issue public on immigration: a group with relatively homogeneous and distinct preferences that are central in shaping their votes (Krosnick, 1990; Ryan and Ehlinger, 2023).

The intervening years have undercut that notion (see also Cisneros, 2017; Velez, 2024). In three consecutive elections, the GOP's standard-bearer touted policies that took a tough line on unauthorized immigration, from highlighting a new wall on the U.S.-Mexico border in 2016 to promises of mass deportations in 2024. And yet, Latinos increased their support for Trump dramatically between 2016 and 2024. What was wrong about the issue public

formulation of Latino public opinion on immigration?

To answer that question, we investigate three related mechanisms that may underpin the relationship between immigration attitudes and vote choice: attitude change, party repositioning, and changing issue weights. Shifts in Latinos' attitudes toward immigration proved helpful in explaining how Trump could improve his margins with Latinos without eschewing his strident opposition to unauthorized immigration. Using high-quality, bilingual surveys of Latinos, we find that between 2016 and 2024, Latinos swung rightward on immigration, significantly reducing the distance between their views and Trump's.

In addition to attitude change, Latinos perceived the GOP to have slightly moderated over this time period. Immigration played just as large a role in Latinos' vote decisions in 2024 as it did in 2016. It's also noteworthy that the anti-immigration swing in Latinos' views paralleled the movement of white Americans—and that white Americans' immigration attitudes were just as predictive of their vote choice as Latinos'. These findings undercut claims that Republicans could only win Latinos by moderating their restrictionist position on immigration.

As Appendix Table A1 demonstrates, scholarship on Latino politics has rarely been positioned to employ population-based samples asking identical questions in English and Spanish, so this manuscript's data sources reflect one contribution. Still, it has noteworthy limitations. For one, we do not have a single panel over the full time period, and so our uncertainty estimates are inflated because we cannot isolate within-respondent changes over long periods of time. We also only have detailed questions about other issues in the 2024 surveys, limiting our capacity to test immigration's influence relative to other issues.

Our results have important implications for theories of campaign effects. A common hypothesis emerging from this strain of research contends that the context of a vote decision—including campaign rhetoric and the information environment—can influence which cognitive considerations are "top of mind" (Carmines and Stimson 1989; Gelman and King 1993; Mendelberg 2001; Valentino, Hutchings and White 2002; Vavreck 2009; Tesler 2012; Sides,

Tesler and Vavreck 2018; but see Lenz 2013). That salience, in turn, is thought to influence the weight of various issues in voters' minds.

However, our results undercut that mechanism as an explanation for Latino voting patterns. Instead, we uncover an eerie consistency in the association between immigration attitudes and vote choice, both across elections and when comparing Latinos to white Americans. One possibility is that immigration has become a perpetually salient issue in the Trump era. From 2015, Trump has defined himself in terms of his immigration views. This may lead to immigration being consistently important in voters' evaluations of him.

This stable integration of attitudes and vote choice, even as Latinos' underlying attitudes on immigration shifted, merits close attention as we seek to revise theories of group politics and persuasion (Pérez and Cobian, 2024). These attitudes appear to be chronically accessible and weighted roughly equally across contexts. Future research, then, should explore the implications of this "politics of perpetual salience."

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A Recent Prior Research

Citation	Survey Data Source	Sampling
Bromo, Gonzalez, Muñoz, & Pathakis (2025)	CMPS (2008–2020)	Opt-in
Fraga, Velez, & West (2025)	Cooperative Election Study (2016, 2020), Targetsmart 2020	Mixed
Múzquiz & Junn (2025)	CMPS (2020), Cooperative Election Study (2020)	Opt-in
Pérez, Lee, & Luna (2025)	Latino National Survey (2006), ANES (2012), Collaborative Multi-Racial Post-Election Survey (2016, 2020), Lab experiment (May 2023)	Mixed
Wakefield (2025)	Cint (2021, 2023)	Opt-in
Cuevas-Molina (2023)	Cooperative Election Study (2010, 2012, 2014, 2016, 2018, 2020)	Opt-in
Hopkins, Kaiser, & Pérez (2023)	KnowledgePanel Latinos Survey	Population
Sides, Tausanovitch, & Vavreck (2022)	Nationscape (2019)	Opt-in
Roman, Walker, & Barreto (2021)	Pew National Latino Survey (2010), Latino National Health and Immigration Survey (2015), CMPS (2016), Latino Decisions Midterm Survey (2018), Latino Decisions Election Eve poll (2018), SOMOS-UNIDOSUS National Survey of Latinos (2020)	Mixed

Table A1: Select studies of Latino voting behavior with survey sources and sampling frames. Studies are published in *APSR*, *AJPS*, *JOP*, *POQ*, or *JREP* 2021-2026.

B Salience of Immigration

To provide a rough assessment of the salience of immigration, we scraped 1,942,243 headlines from Fox News' website between January 2015 and January 2025. We also scraped 630,202 headlines from *The New York Times*, an ideological counterweight to Fox News. We then counted the appearance of the text string "immig" with any following letters in Fox News as well as the *New York Times*, and repeated the process with "president" to provide a baseline related to political coverage.

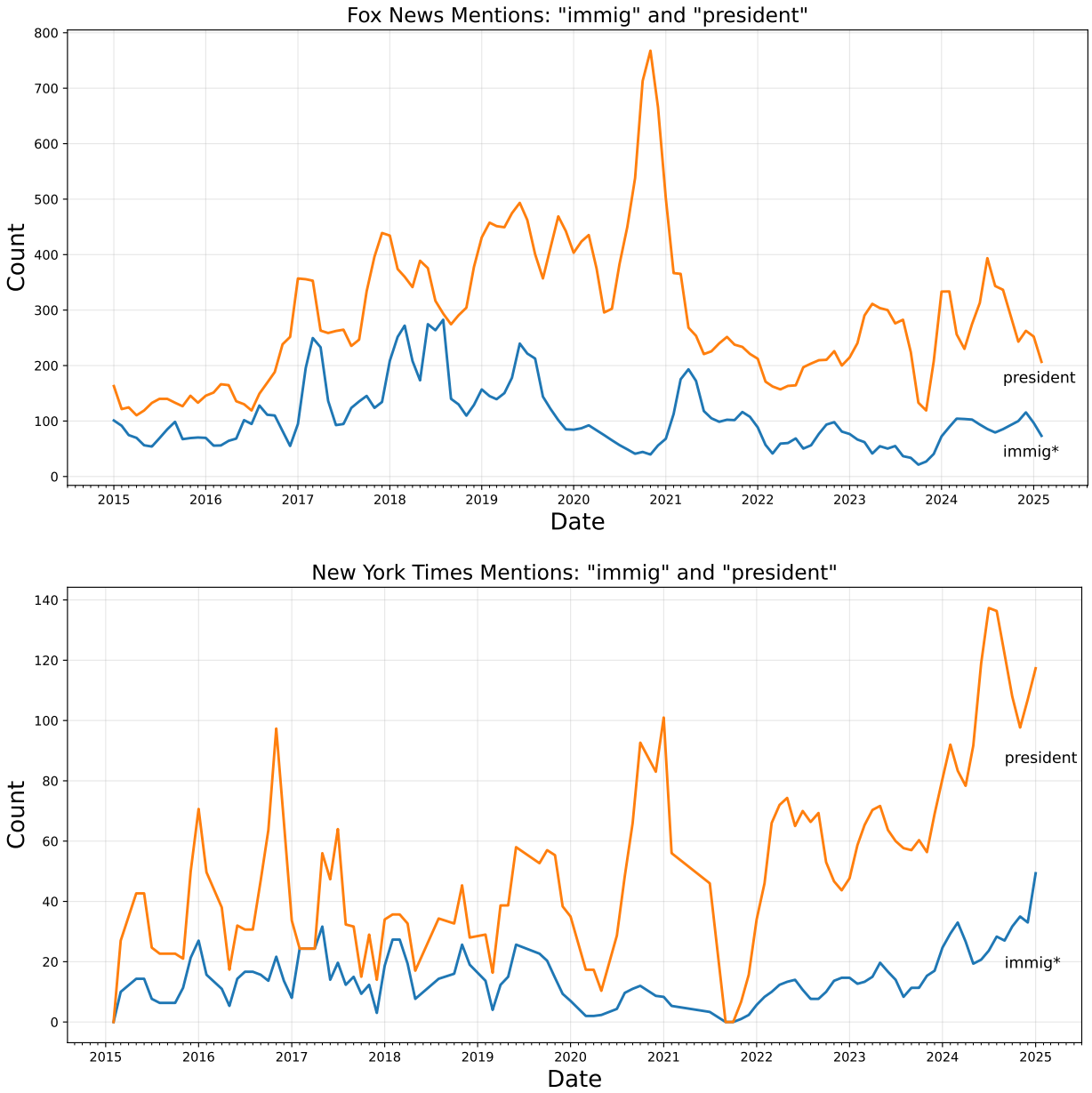

Figure B1: Counts of mentions of "immig*" and "president" in Fox News and *New York Times* headlines over time.

C Formalization of Issue Voting Model

In this section, we present a stylized issue voting model. We use this model to generate empirical predictions about the effects of changes in the distribution of attitudes, party repositioning, and changing issue weights on Latinos' support for Trump.

Suppose each voter has an ideal point on immigration as well as a set of other issues, such as economic policy, LGBTQ rights, abortion, and so on. For expositional simplicity we assume that these secondary issues can be summarized by a single dimension. Denote voter i's ideal point on immigration by x_i and their ideal point on other issues by y_i.

The candidates adopt platforms on immigration and other issues, which we denote by x_j and y_j, with $j \in \{d, r\}$. So, for instance, the Democratic platform on immigration is x_d.

We adopt a random utility model in which the utility that voter i receives from candidate j is a function of i's preferences, j's platform, and a random utility shock:

$$u_{ij} = v(x_i, y_i, x_j, y_j) + e_{ij} \tag{2}$$

$$\equiv v_{ij} + e_{ij}. \tag{3}$$

We furthermore assume a quadratic spatial loss function for the systematic component of utility, in which voters assign weight w to the issue of immigration and $1 - w$ to all other issues:

$$v_{ij} = -[w_t(x_i - x_j)^2 + (1 - w_t)(y_i - y_j)^2] \tag{4}$$

Finally, we assume that the utility shock terms are iid across candidates and voters, $e_{ij} \sim \text{Normal}(0, (1/2)^2)$.

The voter selects the candidate who gives her higher utility,

$$y_i = \underset{j \in \{d,r\}}{\arg\max}\ u_{ij}$$

Given the distributional assumption on v_{ij}, the probability that i votes for the Republican candidate takes the usual probit form:

$$\begin{aligned} p_{ir} &:= Pr(i \text{ votes for Republican}) \\ &= Pr(u_{id} < u_{ir}) \\ &= Pr(v_{id} + e_{id} < v_{ir} + e_{ir}) \\ &= Pr(e_{id} - e_{ir} < v_{ir} - v_{id}) \\ &= \Phi(v_{ir} - v_{id}), \end{aligned}$$

where $\Phi(\cdot)$ is the cdf of the standard normal distribution, using the fact that $e_{ir} - e_{id} \sim \text{Normal}(0, 1)$.

Plugging in for v_{ij} and simplifying terms we obtain:

$$\begin{aligned} p_{ir} &= \Phi\left(w\left[(x_i - x_d)^2 - (x_i - x_r)^2\right] + (1-w)\left[(y_i - y_d)^2 - (y_i - y_r)^2\right]\right) \\ &= \Phi(w(x_d^2 - x_r^2) + (1-w)(y_d^2 - y_r^2) + 2wx_i(x_r - x_d) + 2(1-w)y_i(y_r - y_d)) \end{aligned}$$

Using this expression, we can derive the sources of electoral change—i.e., change in the share of people voting for Republicans.

Attitude Change. What is the effect on vote choice of voter i becoming more conservative on immigration, holding candidate platforms and weights fixed? We model this as an increase in x_i, and take the derivative of the vote choice probability with respect to x_i

$$\frac{\partial p_{ir}}{\partial x_i} = cw(x_r - x_d), \tag{5}$$

where $c := 2\phi(v_{ir} - v_{id}) > 0$. If immigration attitudes become more conservative (increasing x_i), then the probability of voting for the Republican increases so long as the Republican is more conservative than the Democrat. The change in probability is proportional to the

weight placed on immigration w and the candidates' platform divergence $x_r - x_d$.

Candidate Repositioning. What is the effect of one party changing its platform on immigration, holding fixed attitudes, weights, and the platform of the other party? We model this as a small increase in x_j:

$$\frac{\partial p_{ir}}{\partial x_r} = cw(x_i - x_r) \tag{6}$$

$$\frac{\partial p_{ir}}{\partial x_d} = cw(x_d - x_i) \tag{7}$$

$$\tag{8}$$

The first expression says that as the Republican becomes slightly more conservative, the probability that i votes for the Republican decreases so long as the Republican is more conservative than i, and increases otherwise. The second expression says the reverse for Democrats: as the Democrat becomes slightly more conservative, the probability that i votes for the Republican decreases, so as long as the Democrat is more liberal than i, and increases otherwise.

These results capture the intuition that if the parties moderate—i.e., Republicans move leftward or Democrats move rightward—they can increase the probability of winning the support of moderate voters.

Issue Weight. What is the effect of an increase in the weight placed on immigration, holding all else fixed?

$$\frac{\partial p_{ir}}{\partial w} = \frac{1}{2}c\left(\underbrace{\left[(x_i - x_d)^2 - (x_i - x_r)^2\right]}_{\substack{\text{Republican advantage}\\ \text{on immigration}}} - \underbrace{\left[(y_i - y_d)^2 - (y_i - y_r)^2\right]}_{\substack{\text{Republican advantage}\\ \text{on other issues}}}\right) \tag{9}$$

Recall that as the value of $(x_i - x_j)^2$ grows, voter i disagrees with candidate j more, and thus i gets *less* utility from j.

This result says that whether the Republican does better or worse as the voter cares more about immigration vis-a-vis other issues depends on whether the Republican is relatively closer to the voter on immigration or other issues.

D Wording of Key Questions

GfK 2016-2018: "This is about Hispanic ethnicity. Are you of Spanish, Hispanic, or Latino descent?"

CES: "What racial or ethnic group best describes you? White, Black, Hispanic, Asian, Native American, Mixed, Other, Middle Eastern"

"Are you of Spanish, Latino, or Hispanic origin or descent? [Asked if response to race is not Hispanic]"

D.1 Other Issues Measured in NORC 2024

- Thinking about the economy in the country as a whole, would you say that over the past year the nation's economy has gotten better, stayed about the same, or gotten worse? 1–Gotten a lot better, 3–Stayed about the same, 5–Gotten a lot worse
- Do you think the United States is doing too much, too little, or about the right amount to help Ukraine? Too much, too little, about right, Don't know
- In the Middle East conflict, do you side more with the Israelis or more with the Palestinians? Israelis, Palestinians, Neither, Both
- Do you agree or disagree with the following statements? "People should be willing to pay higher prices in order to address global climate change."
- Do you agree or disagree with the following statements? "Unless steps are taken to counteract global warming, there will be bad consequences for human beings."
- Some people think the government should provide fewer services...Other people feel it is important for the government to provide many more services...Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this? 1–Government should provide fewer services; reduce spending a lot; 4–Keep things as they are; 7–Government should provide more services; increase spending a lot

- Some people feel that the government in Washington should make every effort to improve the social and economic position of Black people. Others feel that the government should not make any special effort... Where would you place YOURSELF on this scale? 1–Government should help Black people; 7–Black people should help themselves

- When it comes to racial discrimination, which do you think is the bigger problem for the country today? People seeing racial discrimination where it really does NOT exist; People NOT seeing racial discrimination where it really DOES exist

E CES Immigration Index

We created a scale of attitudes toward immigration using CCES data. The scale averages support for several policies. The exact wording of the questions varies slightly year-to-year, and not all survey years ask about each policy. We restrict our analysis to policies that were polled at least twice between 2018-2024. The wording for the most recent year each policy was polled is as follows:

- "Increase the number of border patrols on the US-Mexican border" (2024 wording)
- "Grant legal status to all illegal immigrants who have held jobs and paid taxes for at least 3 years, and not been convicted of any felony crimes" (2024 wording)
- "Reduce legal immigration by 50 percent over the next 10 years by eliminating the visa lottery and ending family-based migration" (2022 wording)
- "Withhold federal funds from any local police department that does not report to the federal government anyone they identify as an illegal immigrant" (2021 wording)
- "Build a wall between the U.S. and Mexico" (2024 wording)
- "Provide permanent resident status to children of immigrants who were brought to the United States by their parents (also known as Dreamers). Provide these immigrants a pathway to citizenship if they meet the citizenship requirements and have committed no crimes" (2024 wording)

To create the immigration policy scale, we take the z-score for each respondent for the questions they answered and average them together. Higher values indicate more restrictive immigration attitudes. We standardize the scale so that it has mean 0 and variance 1 in 2010.

As an alternative, we generated a scale using a 2-PL item response theory (IRT) model, which allows each item to have a different "discrimination" and "difficulty," learned from the

data. We implement the model using the `emIRT` package in `R` (Imai, Lo and Olmsted, 2015). We find that the IRT-derived estimates and the baseline estimates have a correlation of 0.97. Given that the estimated immigration attitudes are so similar across the two measures, we focus on the simpler scale in the main text.

F VoteCast Immigration Items

As additional evidence for the idea that there have been changes in the distribution of immigration attitudes, we analyze a series of immigration policy questions that were asked in the AP/NORC VoteCast election survey. This survey has been fielded every other year since 2018. The survey contains a mix of a probability sample and an online panel sample, with interviews conducted in both English and Spanish. Pooled over 2018-2024, there are 48,560 Latino respondents. For more information see Press/NORC (2024).

We analyze four questions about immigration. Like the CES, the questions have uneven coverage over time but together cover several areas of immigration policy. The questions are:

- "Which of the following comes closer to your opinion? Should most immigrants who are living in the United States illegally be... (1) Offered a chance to apply for legal status; (2) Deported to the country they came from"
- "Do you favor or oppose each of the following? Building a wall along the U.S.-Mexico border... (1) Strongly favor; (2) Somewhat favor; (3) Somewhat oppose; (4) Strongly oppose"
- "Do you favor or oppose each of the following? Reducing the number of immigrants who are allowed to seek asylum in the U.S. when they arrive at the U.S. border... (1) Strongly favor; (2) Somewhat favor; (3) Somewhat oppose; (4) Strongly oppose"
- "Do you think immigrants in the U.S. today do more to... (1) Help the country; (2) Hurt the country"

We recode answers to be 1 if the respondent gave a restrictionist/conservative answer and 0 otherwise. Figure F2 shows the weighted means by Latino ethnicity.There is a general turn toward more restrictionist attitudes among both Latinos and non-Latinos. This pattern is especially evident in the question most similar to the *Pathway* question that we analyze in

the main text. In 2018, 21% of Latinos said that most immigrants living in the U.S. illegally should be deported. By 2024, that share had risen above 33%.

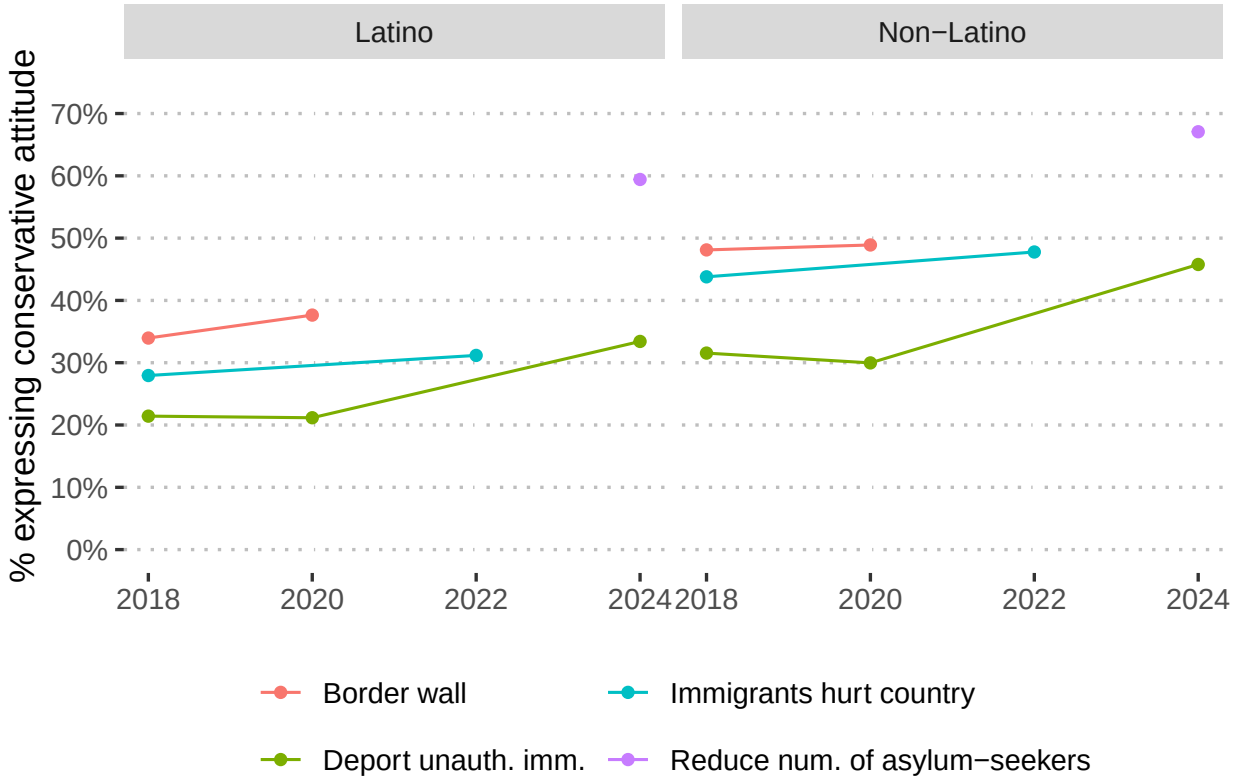

Figure F2: AP VoteCast immigration questions

G Descriptive Statistics

Table G2: Descriptive Statistics: 2016-2018 Latino Panel with ACS 2016 Comparison

	Spring 2016		Fall 2016		Fall 2018		ACS 2016	
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	(Source)
Education (Years)	12.387	3.340	12.440	3.226	12.838	2.887	11.5	(a)
Income ($1,000s)	67.794	51.408	73.133	51.428	71.590	55.362	47.7	(b)
Female	0.495	0.500	0.500	0.496	0.553	0.500	0.51	(c)
Age / 100	0.416	0.167	0.399	0.165	0.398	0.160		
Mexican Ancestry	0.581	0.496	0.562	0.498	0.531	0.501	0.62	(e)
Puerto Rican Ancestry	0.126	0.351	0.133	0.361	0.159	0.379	0.095	(e)
Born in U.S.	0.651	0.478	0.665	0.465	0.699	0.453	0.84	(f)
Spanish Interview	0.321	0.470	0.286	0.444	0.187	0.394	—	
GOP Partisanship (1-7)	3.018	1.934	3.065	1.972	3.118	2.004	—	

Notes: This table presents weighted means and standard deviations for key demographic variables for the 2016-2018 Latino panel (as measured in wave one). There were 572 wave one Latino citizen respondents, 322 wave two Latino citizen respondents, and 168 wave three Latino citizen respondents. ACS 2016 column presents American Community Survey estimates for the Hispanic/Latino population.
ACS Sources: (a) Estimated from educational attainment distribution (67% high school completion, 15% bachelor's+); (b) Median household income ($47,675, Census Bureau 2017); (c) Sex ratio from Census population estimates; (e) Hispanic origin composition (Pew Research Center analysis of Census data); (f) Percent native-born among Hispanic citizens (67% native-born + 13% naturalized = 80% citizens; 67/80 = 84% of citizens are native-born).
Note on ACS comparisons: ACS estimates are for the full Hispanic/Latino population, while survey samples are restricted to Latino adult citizens. Survey respondents show higher mean age (41.6 years vs. median 28 years) and higher income, consistent with the citizen adult subpopulation being older and more educated than the overall Hispanic population.

G.1 Decomposing Latino Voting in 2016 and 2024

In Appendix Table G4, we use regression models of voting in the two surveys with the largest population-based samples—the first waves of the 2016-2018 and 2024 panels—to identify the associations between basic demographics and Latinos' vote choices. Few surveys offer either consistent sampling frames or sufficient sample sizes to permit such analyses, and these analyses provide valuable context for our subsequent study of immigration attitudes. The outcome is coded with 1 indicating support for Trump, 0 indicated people who are undecided, not planning to vote or support a third-party candidate, and -1 indicating support for the Democrat.

Table G3: Descriptive Statistics: 2024 Latino Survey with ACS 2024 Comparison

	Wave 1		Wave 2		ACS 2024	
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD	Mean	(Source)
Education (Years)	13.095	2.081	13.265	2.016	12.5	(a)
Income ($1,000s)	71.166	60.179	64.955	53.907	71.0	(b)
Female	0.484	0.500	0.488	0.500	0.51	(c)
Age (Years)	42.893	16.022	45.233	15.812		
Mexican Ancestry	0.419	0.500	0.436	0.500	0.60	(e)
Puerto Rican Ancestry	0.147	0.335	0.161	0.340	0.09	(e)
Born in U.S.	0.789	0.421	0.807	0.416	0.84	(f)
Spanish Interview	0.107	0.312	0.088	0.300	—	
GOP Partisanship (1-7)	3.635	2.017	3.599	2.041	—	

Notes: This table presents weighted means and standard deviations for key demographic variables measured in wave one for the Latino respondents to the two waves of the 2024 survey, with the 659 wave one Latino citizen respondents at left and the 460 wave two Latino citizen respondents at right. ACS 2024 column presents American Community Survey estimates for the Hispanic/Latino population.
ACS Sources: (a) Estimated from educational attainment distribution (21% bachelor's+ among eligible voters, increased from 2016); (b) Median household income ($70,950, Census Bureau 2025); (c) Sex ratio from Census population estimates; (e) Hispanic origin composition (Pew Research Center); (f) Percent native-born among Hispanic citizens (67% native-born + 13% naturalized = 80% citizens; 67/80 = 84% of citizens are native-born).
Note on ACS comparisons: ACS estimates are for the full Hispanic/Latino population, while survey samples are restricted to Latino adult citizens. Survey respondents show higher mean age (42.9 years vs. median 31 years) and lower Mexican ancestry proportion, consistent with geographic and demographic differences between the citizen adult subpopulation and the overall Hispanic population.

We find that some predictors have consistent effects, with Cuban-descended respondents more likely to support the GOP candidate in both waves. However, age becomes a significantly more negative predictor of backing the GOP while taking the survey in Spanish becomes less so. Being more comfortable in Spanish was more predictive of Democratic support in 2016 than 2024. Although the difference across the surveys isn't statistically significant, education is a somewhat stronger predictor in 2024, too. In both years, women are somewhat less likely to back the GOP, but not significantly so.

	Spring 2016		Spring 2024		
	β	SE	β	SE	P-value
Education (Years)	-0.008	0.013	-0.031	0.018	0.301
Spanish Survey	-0.340	0.115	0.093	0.123	0.010
Income (in 10,000s)	0.005	0.008	-0.005	0.006	0.323
Age (Years)	0.003	0.003	-0.005	0.002	0.018
Female	-0.006	0.079	-0.045	0.070	0.720
Born in U.S.	0.094	0.110	0.018	0.099	0.602
Mexican	-0.069	0.099	-0.085	0.083	0.926
Cuban	0.441	0.174	0.398	0.136	0.859
Puerto Rican	0.152	0.133	0.171	0.119	0.917

Table G4: This table reports regressions of support for Trump (1) versus the Democrat (-1) on various demographic variables. The final column reports two-sided p-values that the coefficients are different.

G.2 Share of Latino Respondents Closer to Each Party Over Time

Table G5 displays the self-placement and party-placement evidence (from Figure 4) in a new way. It shows the fraction of respondents whose self-placement is closer to perceptions of the Democrats' position, closer to the Republicans' position, or equally distant from both. Even in the fall of 2024, 43% of respondents were closer to Democrats—but that percentage was down substantially from 59% in fall 2016. The percentage reporting being closer to Republicans rose from 21% to 32% in the same period. While Latinos overall are still more aligned with the Democrats, this advantage has substantially eroded during the Trump Era.

	Closer to Republicans	Closer to Democrats	Equally Distant
Fall 2016	20.9%	59.2%	19.9%
Fall 2018	25.7%	58.1%	16.2%
Winter 2020	28.7%	52.1%	19.1%
Fall 2020	26.7%	59.0%	14.3%
Winter 2024	29.4%	41.9%	28.7%
Fall 2024	32.4%	42.6%	25.0%

Table G5: Fraction of U.S. citizen Latino respondents indicating that their unauthorized immigration views are closer to each party's.

H Additional Attitude Change Analyses

H.1 Latinos Remain Distinctively Pro-Pathway

	Oct 2012	Nov/Dec 2012	Jan 2016	Oct 2016	Oct 2018	Jan 2020	Oct 2020	Feb/Mar 2024	Sep/Oct 2024
Intercept	0.113	−0.271	0.237	0.020	−0.018	1.337*	1.259*	2.008*	1.815*
	(0.386)	(0.381)	(0.482)	(0.591)	(0.636)	(0.624)	(0.634)	(0.296)	(0.353)
Latino	0.826*	0.881*	0.527*	0.539*	0.475*	0.666*	0.451*	0.724*	0.687*
	(0.146)	(0.143)	(0.177)	(0.211)	(0.222)	(0.230)	(0.228)	(0.146)	(0.174)
Black	1.148*	1.026*	0.874*	1.008*	1.201*	1.301*	0.963*	0.498*	0.710*
	(0.134)	(0.131)	(0.160)	(0.204)	(0.223)	(0.217)	(0.216)	(0.160)	(0.189)
Education	0.212*	0.235*	0.237*	0.242*	0.266*	0.187*	0.172*	0.146*	0.178*
	(0.021)	(0.021)	(0.026)	(0.032)	(0.035)	(0.034)	(0.034)	(0.021)	(0.025)
Income	0.001	0.000	−0.001	−0.001	0.000	0.000	0.001	0.007	−0.026
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.012)	(0.015)
Female	0.236*	0.215*	0.204	0.373*	0.358*	0.456*	0.316*	0.628*	0.626*
	(0.086)	(0.084)	(0.104)	(0.126)	(0.139)	(0.138)	(0.135)	(0.098)	(0.115)
Age	0.003	0.007*	−0.000	0.006	−0.001	−0.005	0.006	−0.018*	−0.016*
	(0.003)	(0.003)	(0.004)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.006)	(0.003)	(0.003)
R^2	0.117	0.122	0.101	0.100	0.125	0.099	0.066	0.070	0.075
N	2250	2264	1530	1129	939	1037	1061	2092	1507

$^*p < 0.05$

Table H6: For the ISCAP and NORC panels, this table reports regression coefficients predicting the 1-7 deportation vs. pathway to citizenship scale for all respondents.

	2016 (GfK)	2024 (NORC)	2024 (NORC)
Intercept	-0.612^*	-0.509	1.009^*
	(0.204)	(0.271)	(0.335)
GOP Immig. Advantage	0.075^*	0.053^*	0.111^*
	(0.012)	(0.011)	(0.014)
Education	0.001	-0.003	-0.036
	(0.011)	(0.017)	(0.021)
Spanish Interview	-0.070	-0.050	-0.129
	(0.100)	(0.117)	(0.151)
Female	-0.075	-0.084	-0.133
	(0.067)	(0.065)	(0.082)
Age	0.001	-0.002	-0.001
	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.003)
Income	-0.001	-0.019^*	-0.003
	(0.001)	(0.008)	(0.011)
Born in US	0.009	0.146	-0.045
	(0.087)	(0.086)	(0.107)
PID: Weak Dem	0.091	0.239^*	
	(0.101)	(0.098)	
PID: Ind Dem	0.219^*	0.142	
	(0.100)	(0.122)	
PID: Ind	0.635^*	0.722^*	
	(0.170)	(0.114)	
PID: Ind GOP	0.631^*	1.494^*	
	(0.112)	(0.154)	
PID: Weak GOP	0.847^*	1.366^*	
	(0.143)	(0.132)	
PID: Strong GOP	0.977^*	1.608^*	
	(0.135)	(0.120)	
Nat'l Econ.			-0.175^*
			(0.036)
R^2	0.516	0.575	0.290
Adj. R^2	0.491	0.560	0.275
Num. obs.	267	388	385

$^*p < 0.05$

Table H7: Regression models of supporting Trump (1) over the Democrat (-1) or neither (0) with additional covariates including partisanship and national retrospective economic perceptions.

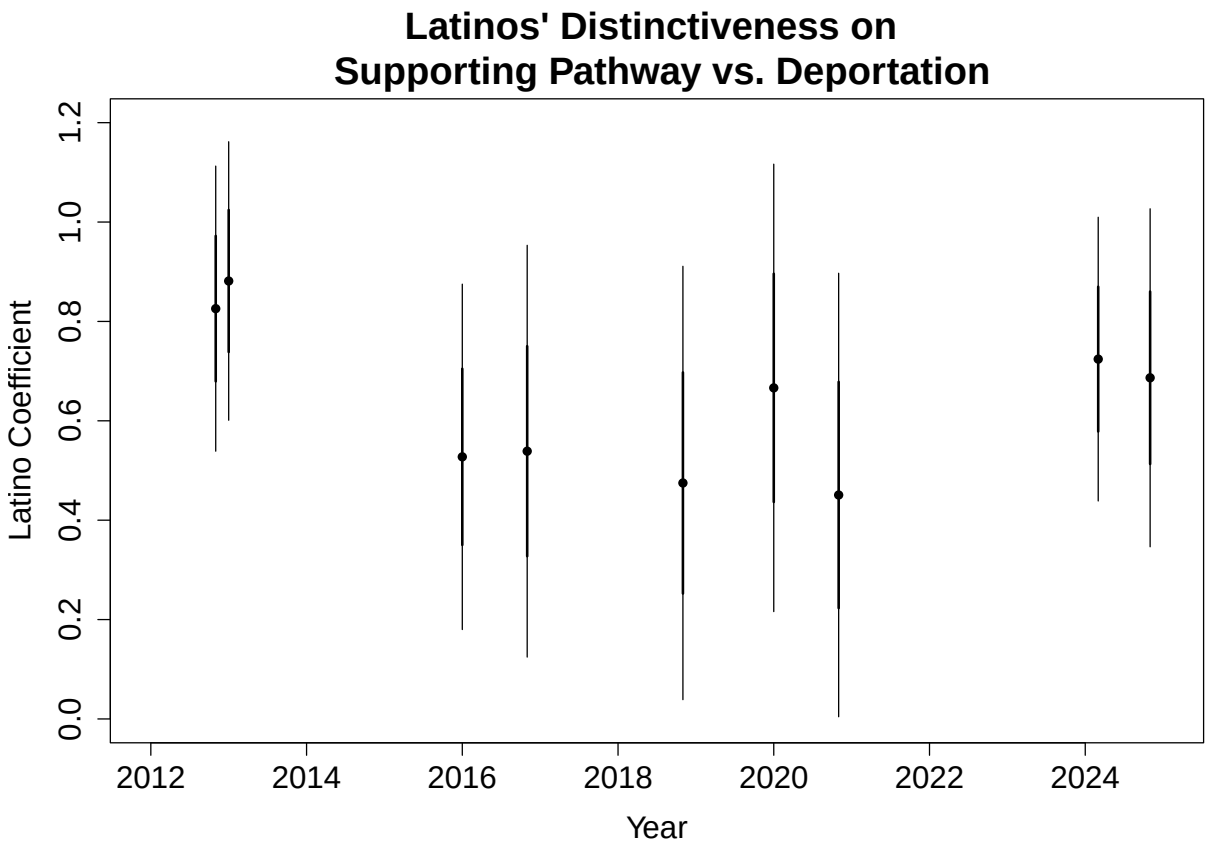

Figure H3: Coefficients associated with identifying as Latino in regression of support for pathway to citizenship (7) versus deportation (1). Data: ISCAP (2012-2020) and NORC (2024) panels. Baseline is respondents who do not identify as Latino or Black.

***Controls include identifying as Black. See full model specifications in Table H6*

	Spring 2016	Winter 2024
Intercept	5.134*	3.764*
	(0.568)	(0.607)
Education (Years)	0.049	0.068
	(0.030)	(0.040)
Spanish Interview	0.952*	0.248
	(0.257)	(0.333)
Female	0.077	0.644*
	(0.181)	(0.189)
Age	−1.082	−0.020*
	(0.570)	(0.006)
Income	−0.153	−1.409
	(1.853)	(1.553)
Born in U.S.	−0.796*	−0.010
	(0.238)	(0.267)
Mexican Ancestry	0.455*	0.534*
	(0.183)	(0.195)
Adj. R^2	0.101	0.043
Num. obs.	485	594

$^{*}p < 0.05$

Table H8: Models of Latino respondents' support for deportation (1) vs. a pathway (7) from the spring 2016 GfK wave (left) and the spring 2024 NORC wave (right).

H.2 Mexican-Americans Are More Supportive of a Pathway Through 2024

In the period of nearly nine years spanned by our data, the composition of unauthorized immigrants at the southern border has shifted (Van Hook, Gelatt and Ruiz Soto, 2023), so another possible explanation is that Mexican-descended respondents—the plurality national origin group among Latinos—have become disproportionately more restrictionist. However, Appendix Table H8 demonstrates that Mexican-descended respondents are consistently more supportive of a pathway to citizenship than are other Latinos, though they also become more restrictionist by 2024. In short, we do find substantial evidence for *attitude change* among Latinos overall on immigration, although not one driven disproportionately by those of Mexican descent.

H.3 Analysis of Individual CES Survey Items

In Figures H4 and H5, we show how Latinos' attitudes have changed on individual items in the CES immigration scale. There are broad increases in restrictionist sentiment across items. For example, Figure H4 shows that Latinos' support for increasing border patrols increased from just under 40% in 2016 to over 60% in 2023. Similarly, support for requiring local police to report undocumented immigrants rose from around 22% in 2017 to around 42% in 2021 (the last year this question was asked).

Figure H5 plots the time series for all CES items, along with a loess line. This result shows the same temporal pattern as the main results we present in Figure 3 of the main text.

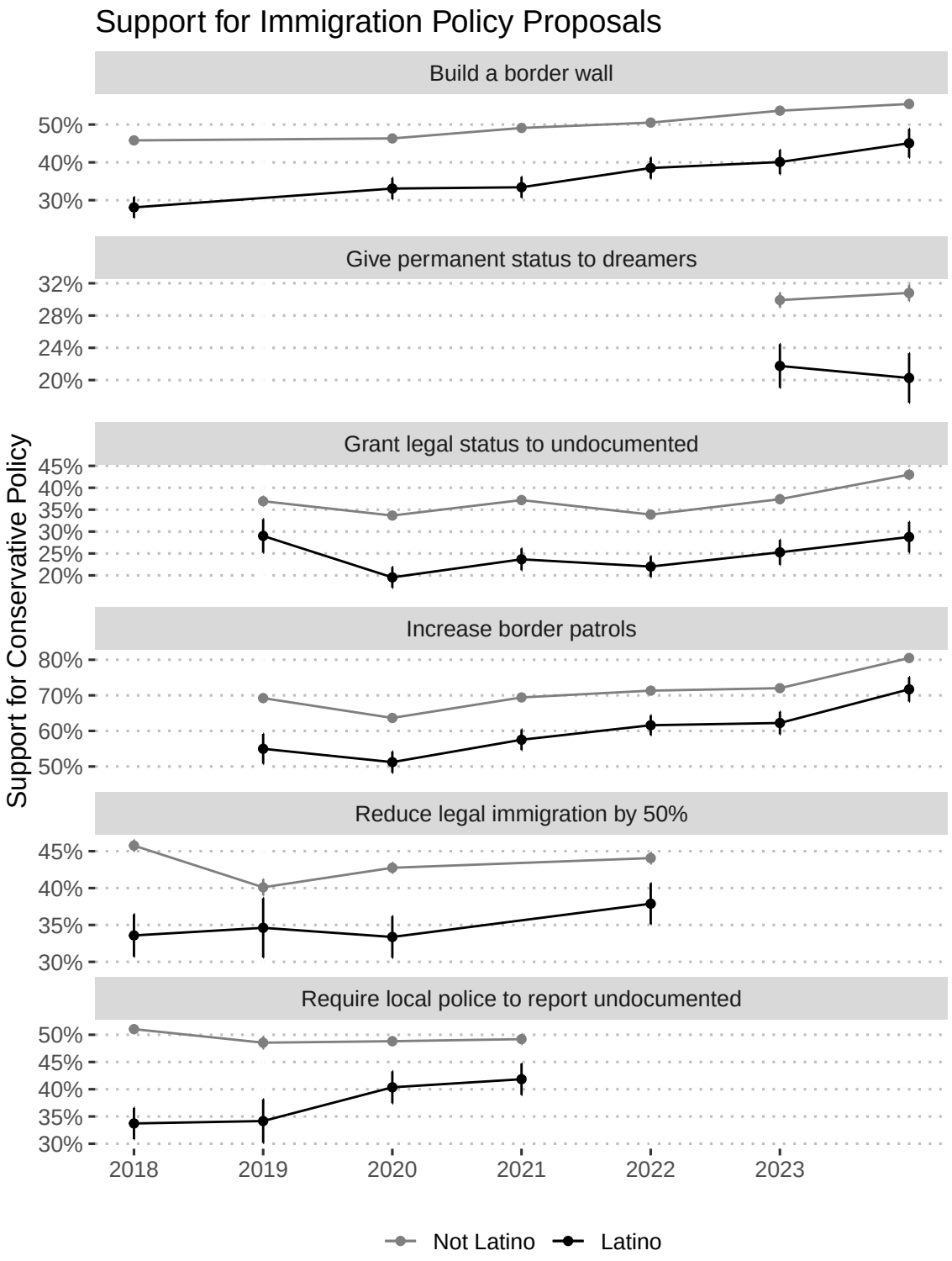

Figure H4: Views on select immigration policy proposals, 2018-2024. Variables are coded so higher values indicate the more restrictionist position. Source: CES.

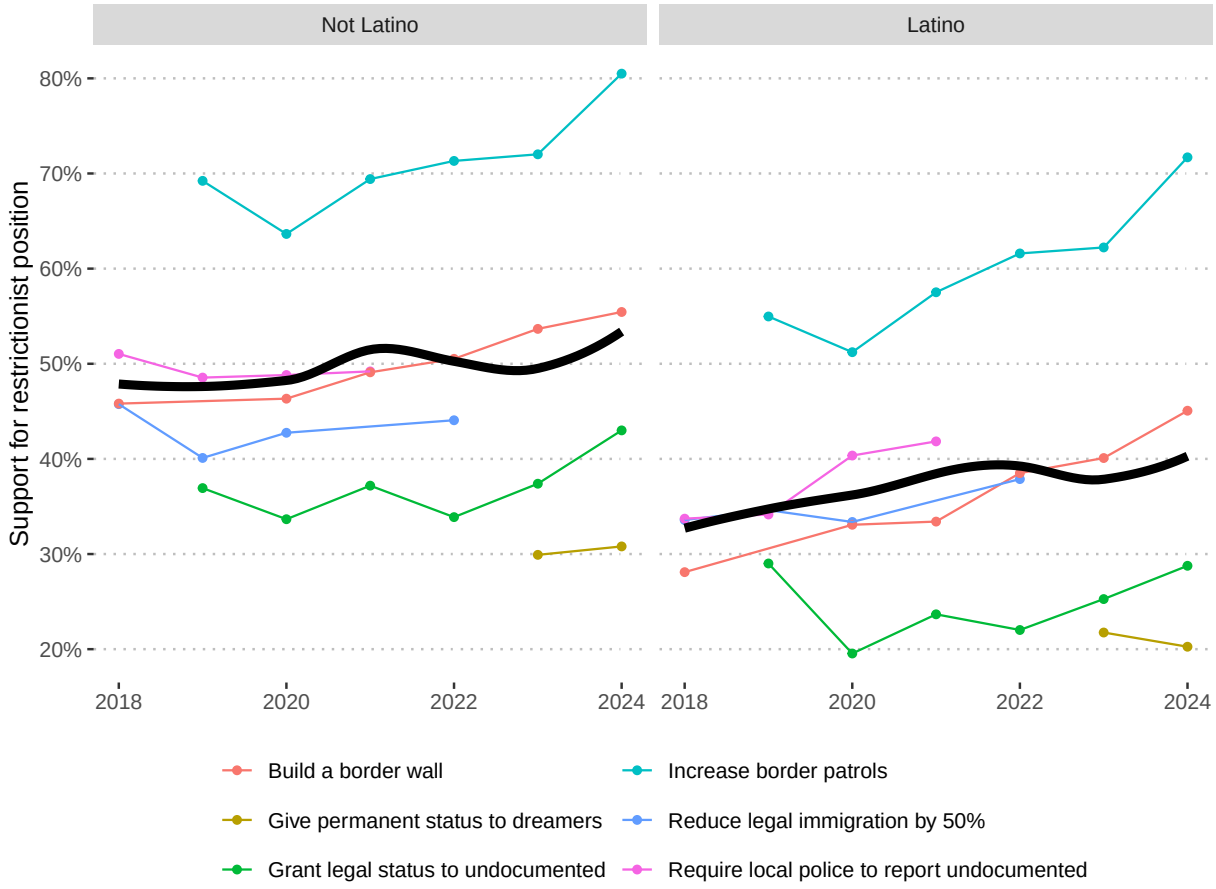

Figure H5: Attitudes on individual immigration issues, 2018-2024. Black line shows loess line, fit to means of individual items, weighted by the inverse of the standard error of the mean. Variables are coded so higher values indicate the more restrictionist position. Source: CES

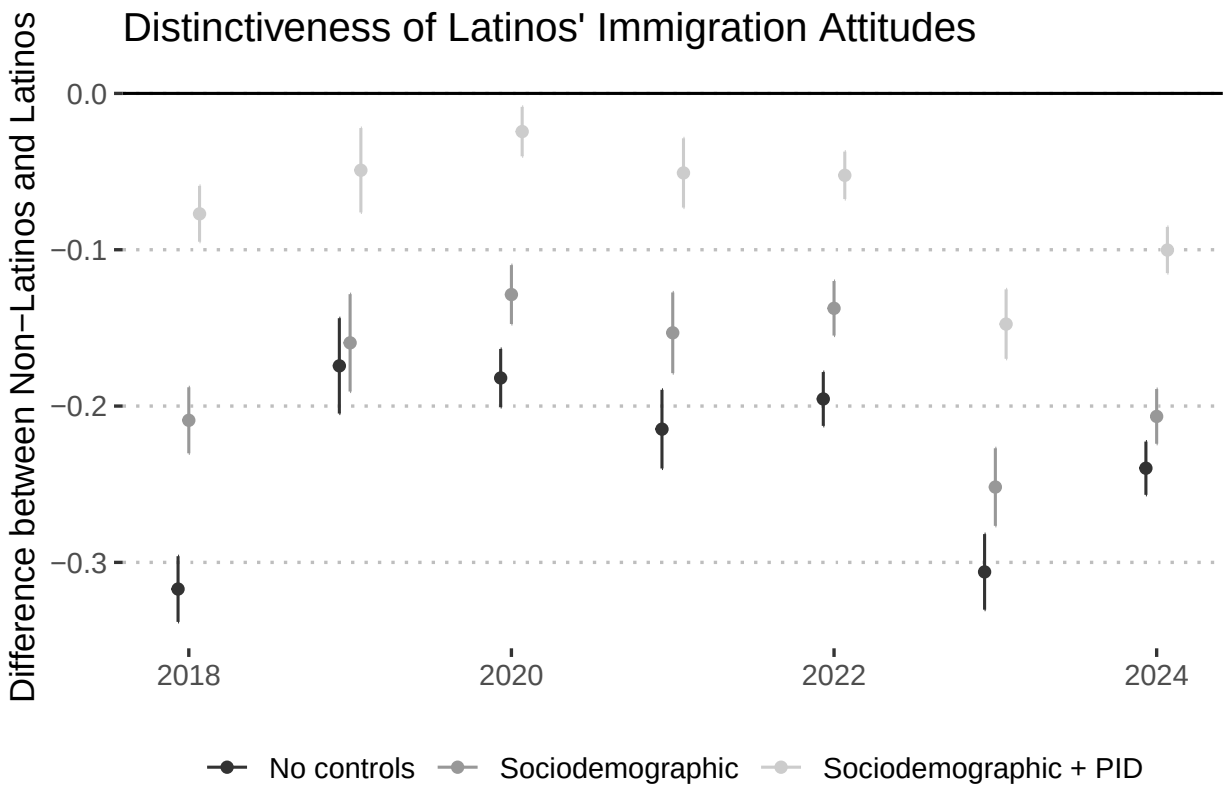

Figure H6: Outcome is respondents' score on the immigration restrictionism index. Points show coefficients associated with identifying as Latino. Baseline is non-Hispanic, non-Black respondents. Sociodemographic controls include age, gender, education, and income. Data: CCES (2018-2024).

I Additional Issue Weight Models

I.1 Within-Campaign Stability

Researchers have debated how best to interpret regressions of vote choice on issue attitudes, with some researchers interpreting them in light of the salience of political issues and/or theories of priming and others dissenting (Lenz, 2013; Sides, Tesler and Vavreck, 2019; Hopkins, 2021; Grimmer, Marble and Tanigawa-Lau, 2024). Still, there is widespread acknowledgment that the coefficients indicate the strength of the linear relationship between a given issue attitude and vote choice. Here, we present results from such regressions estimated within campaigns to examine the relationship between Latinos' immigration attitudes and their voting preferences—and how (if at all) such relationships shift over time. Here, we follow prior work on activation by estimating models which regress vote choice on a key attitudinal measure alongside basic demographics (Lenz, 2013; Sides, Tesler and Vavreck, 2018; Hopkins, 2021).

As Table I9 shows, the coefficient mapping support for a pathway to citizenship (over deportation) was -0.184 (SE=0.019) in the spring of 2016 and a virtually identical -0.182 (SE=0.020) in the fall of 2016, indicating that immigration attitudes were equally integrated with Latinos' vote choice in the two survey waves. If the salience of rhetoric on immigration did serve to prime that issue attitude, any such priming took place prior to March 2016.

How did the relationships look eight years later in 2024? 2024 presented citizens with a very different information environment, albeit one in which immigration was again a salient issue. In Table I10, we present parallel regressions for Latino citizens in 2024. Here, too, the coefficients are highly stable, with values of -0.192 (SE=0.017) in winter 2024 and -0.188 (SE=0.018) roughly seven months later. The fact that there was again little change over the course of the campaign indicates that the relationship between immigration attitudes and vote choice was quite fixed; the similarity between these coefficients and those for 2016 suggests that the remarkable stability in the correlates of vote choice may be a constant of

	Spring 2016	Fall 2016
Intercept	0.565*	0.426
	(0.253)	(0.260)
Pathway (vs. Deportation)	−0.184*	−0.182*
	(0.019)	(0.020)
Education	−0.005	0.005
	(0.012)	(0.012)
Spanish Interview	−0.162	−0.042
	(0.112)	(0.116)
Female	−0.034	−0.018
	(0.075)	(0.078)
Age	0.203	0.040
	(0.235)	(0.246)
Income	0.329	−0.337
	(0.766)	(0.798)
Born in U.S.	−0.080	0.038
	(0.100)	(0.105)
Adj. R^2	0.262	0.247
Num. obs.	294	287

$^{*}p < 0.05$

Table I9: For Latino respondents, regressions of 2016 vote choice on independent variables including a pathway to citizenship measured in waves 1 (column 1) and 2 (column 2).

	Winter 2024	Fall 2024
Intercept	1.586*	1.386*
	(0.327)	(0.332)
Pathway (vs. Deportation)	−0.192*	−0.188*
	(0.017)	(0.018)
Education	−0.036	−0.030
	(0.020)	(0.021)
Spanish Interview	0.241	−0.032
	(0.139)	(0.144)
Female	0.021	−0.090
	(0.079)	(0.082)
Age	−0.009*	−0.005
	(0.003)	(0.003)
Income	0.000	−0.001
	(0.001)	(0.001)
Born in U.S.	−0.008	0.004
	(0.104)	(0.106)
Adj. R^2	0.238	0.213
Num. obs.	417	417

$^{*}p < 0.05$

Table I10: For Latino respondents, regressions of 2024 vote choice on independent variables including a pathway to citizenship measured in waves 1 (column 1) and 2 (column 2).

the Trump/Biden era.

	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
Intercept	0.565^{*}	0.092	0.426
	(0.253)	(0.271)	(0.260)
Pathway (vs. Deportation); Wave 1	-0.184^{***}	-0.128^{***}	
	(0.019)	(0.021)	
Education	−0.005	−0.006	0.005
	(0.012)	(0.013)	(0.012)
Spanish Interview	−0.162	−0.082	−0.042
	(0.112)	(0.120)	(0.116)
Female	−0.034	−0.095	−0.018
	(0.075)	(0.080)	(0.078)
Age	0.203	0.431	0.040
	(0.235)	(0.252)	(0.246)
Income	0.329	−0.041	−0.337
	(0.766)	(0.822)	(0.798)
Born in U.S.	−0.080	0.137	0.038
	(0.100)	(0.107)	(0.105)
Pathway (vs. Deportation); Wave 2			-0.182^{***}
			(0.020)
Adj. R^2	0.262	0.148	0.247
Num. obs.	294	294	287

$^{***}p < 0.001$; $^{**}p < 0.01$; $^{*}p < 0.05$

Table I11: For Latino respondents, regressions of 2016 vote choice on independent variables including a pathway to citizenship measured in waves 1 (columns 1-2) and 2 (column 3).

	vs. Biden	vs. Harris	vs. Harris	vs. Biden	vs. Harris	vs. Harris
Intercept	1.586*	1.736*	1.386*	−0.285	−0.225	−0.280
	(0.327)	(0.347)	(0.332)	(0.273)	(0.290)	(0.272)
Pathway W1	−0.192*	−0.165*		−0.082*	−0.049*	
	(0.017)	(0.018)		(0.014)	(0.015)	
Pathway W2			−0.188*			−0.072*
			(0.018)			(0.015)
Education	−0.036	−0.054*	−0.030	0.002	−0.014	−0.004
	(0.020)	(0.021)	(0.021)	(0.015)	(0.016)	(0.016)
Spanish Interview	0.241	0.015	−0.032	0.242*	0.033	0.007
	(0.139)	(0.147)	(0.144)	(0.105)	(0.111)	(0.108)
Female	0.021	−0.099	−0.090	0.058	−0.061	−0.052
	(0.079)	(0.084)	(0.082)	(0.060)	(0.063)	(0.062)
Age	−0.009*	−0.007*	−0.005	−0.006*	−0.004	−0.003
	(0.003)	(0.003)	(0.003)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)
Income	0.000	−0.001	−0.001	−0.000	−0.001*	−0.001*
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)
Born in U.S.	−0.008	−0.068	0.004	0.124	0.098	0.138
	(0.104)	(0.110)	(0.106)	(0.080)	(0.085)	(0.082)
Weak Dem				0.252*	0.275*	0.239*
				(0.092)	(0.097)	(0.094)
Lean Dem				0.194	0.248*	0.164
				(0.114)	(0.121)	(0.117)
Independent				0.955*	0.873*	0.806*
				(0.101)	(0.107)	(0.106)
Lean GOP				1.419*	1.563*	1.484*
				(0.145)	(0.154)	(0.152)
Weak GOP				1.370*	1.458*	1.407*
				(0.125)	(0.133)	(0.127)
Strong GOP				1.577*	1.701*	1.634*
				(0.113)	(0.120)	(0.112)
Adj. R^2	0.238	0.177	0.213	0.575	0.539	0.567
Num. obs.	417	417	417	417	417	417

*$p < 0.05$

Table I12: This table predicts 2024 support for Trump in Feb./March (against Biden; columns 1 and 4) and Sept./Oct. (against Harris; columns 2, 3, 5 and 6) for Latino panelists.

	Δ Vote Choice
Intercept	-0.056^{*}
	(0.028)
Δ *Pathway*	-0.045^{*}
	(0.014)
Δ GOP Party ID	0.048
	(0.029)
R^2	0.033
Adj. R^2	0.028
Num. obs.	394

$^{*}p < 0.05$

Table I13: For the 2024 NORC survey, this table reports a regression of the change in vote choice on the change in immigration attitudes and partisan identification.

J Issue Weight Results for Non-Hispanic Whites

	Oct. '16	Feb. '24	Sept. '24
(Intercept)	−0.183	0.857*	1.123*
	(0.249)	(0.224)	(0.220)
Gop Immig. Advantage	0.144*	0.143*	0.147*
	(0.007)	(0.011)	(0.010)
Education	0.001	−0.056*	−0.069*
	(0.014)	(0.016)	(0.016)
Income	−0.000	−0.001	−0.008
	(0.001)	(0.010)	(0.010)
Female	−0.073	−0.022	−0.144*
	(0.051)	(0.072)	(0.072)
Age	0.004*	−0.000	−0.000
	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)
Adj. R^2	0.393	0.332	0.360
Num. obs.	737	448	476

$^*p < 0.05$

Table J14: These models employ the ISCAP data (October 2016) and the NORC data (February and September 2024) for non-Hispanic white respondents to examine the predictive power of contemporaneously measured attitudes on a pathway to citizenship and basic covariates.